- Limiting access to specific tables to a few users (e.g., to one department in the organization)
- Limiting access to tables to isolate different applications (e.g., hosting multiple applications for different customers on the same database)

User and access management varies between database systems. We don't cover this topic in this book; refer to your database system's documentation for details.

10.5 Building on a highly available database

The availability of our blog cloudonaut.io is key to our business success. That's the case for your WordPress site as well. Therefore, you should avoid downtimes when possible. This chapter is about increasing the availability of your database.

The database is typically the most important part of a system. Applications won't work if they can't connect to the database, and the data stored in the database is mission critical, so the database must be highly available and store data durably.

Amazon RDS lets you launch highly available (HA) databases. Compared to a default database consisting of a single database instance, an HA RDS database consists of two database instances: a primary and a standby database instance. You will be paying for both instances. All clients send requests to the primary database. Data is replicated between the primary and the standby database synchronously, as shown in figure 10.5.